

EDUCATION FOR TOMORROW'S WORLD

Education has always leaned towards the paradox, where thoughts of the day may be in conflict with the needs of tomorrow. With the rapidly changing world in which we live, education must increasingly focus on the needs of tomorrow, but herein lies yet another paradox – we are having to teach the students of today how to answer the questions of tomorrow – but we don't know what those questions will be.

Jean-Francois Rischard in his book, *High Noon – Twenty Global Issues; Twenty Years to Solve Them* – gives us an indication not of the questions, but of the nature of the world, and the attributes that our students need to respond to those unknown questions. He gives four key characteristics of the modern world:

- That it is fast moving – so we must be agile in our thinking
- That it crosses national boundaries – so we must excel at networking
- That it is knowledge intensive – so we must be life long learners
- That it is intensely competitive – so we must be consistent yet flexible

Education is the key not only for exploiting the opportunities that this world offers, but also for resolving the challenges – challenges of demographics, of social inequality, of sustainable development.

I question whether the traditional fact based systems of education are best suited to meet these challenges – 'It is possible to store the mind with a million facts, and still be entirely uneducated' wrote Alec Bourne. Enquiry based learning, as exemplified by the International Baccalaureate Organisation and by some other school based learning programmes, aims to enable students to explore interrelated issues and hence to learn through their experience what, perhaps, we learnt through facts.

We, at the Council of International Schools, believe that the attributes noted by Jean-Francois Rischard can best be achieved through schools that encompass the concept of internationalism within their mission, curriculum, policies and practices, so providing opportunities for learners to develop:

- A personal code of ethics, though meaningful engagement with issues of principle, explored from multiple perspectives, and with their school as a model of ethical practice
- A global perspective, through an understanding of issues of diversity, peace and conflict, sustainable development and social justice
- Empathy to diversity, gaining a perspective and self knowledge through meaningful engagement in their own beliefs and values with those of others
- Competency in communication in the language of instruction, another language and in their mother tongue
- The disposition to participate actively in their local and global communities through meaningful, reflective experiences.
- An understanding of, and comfort in, leadership through the collaborative resolution of problems by responding and supporting differing opinions.

If education is, as the American historian Will Durant once said, 'A progressive discovery of our own ignorance', the learners of today will have but thanks for the educators of today if we succeed in giving them the attributes to succeed in tomorrow's world – and resentment if we fail to do so.

Stonehill International School, Bangalore

As you head north out of Bangalore towards the new airport, you will see on your left side a white granite hill rising above the surrounding countryside. Tucked away on a 30 acre site in the clean country air, you find Stonehill International School – a new purpose built campus catering for the needs an international community valuing a true international education for their children.

Because we live in a rapidly changing, interconnected and complex world, preparing our children to succeed in this environment requires a dynamic school. One that turns learning into a life-long journey of enquiry and discovery, culminating in knowledge that matters – knowledge gained through experience and experimentation which is at the core of the educational programmes provided by the International Baccalaureate Organisation (IBO)

Stonehill is such a school, with a global faculty and an international curriculum. The Stonehill community of learners – teachers, students and parents – will experience an incredible opportunity in examining change, exploring the interconnectiveness of issues and developing a global perspective through the educational programmes of the IBO. Stonehill believes that these programmes, now benefitting 650,000 students in 2,400 schools around the world, provide an education better suited to the needs of the modern world than fact based learning prevalent in traditional schools.

Learning at Stonehill will be an exciting journey of discovery, providing students with a broad based educational programme that extends learning beyond the academic to the social, ethical, physical, creative and emotional development of each child. Through community service and involvement, students will begin to understand to respect differences, appreciate diversity and, above all, recognize through it all our common humanity

Within Stonehill's safe and secure grounds are spacious buildings, state-of-art technology, sports facilities that match those of the finest schools around the world and a range of extra-curricular activities to stimulate the interest of all.

Stonehill International School is an education initiative of the Embassy Group, one of India's largest real estate developers.

